revenge for her fallen colleagues. Nalini admitted that she was left speechless by Dhanu's composure.

Dhanu had got it from her family. On 10 June, when Prabhakaran made his first public appearance since the assassination, eight eminent Tamils were honoured by the LTTE for their contribution to the Tamil Eelam. Among those honoured were Kasi Anandan, Prabhakaran's political adviser, and, posthumously, Rajaratnam, a Sri Lankan Tamil who, according to many, was like a mentor to Prabhakaran—he had died in 1975. At a function in Jaffna, Prabhakaran gave away gold medals and cash rewards for each of the eight. According to reports confirmed then by the Sri Lankan army and R&AW's Colombo desk, Dhanu was Rajaratnam's daughter. Dhanu's family performed her last rites a day after Rajaratnam was honoured posthumously; no one but Prabhakaran attended the ceremony.[11]

Nalini had managed half a day's leave from office on the pretext of going to Kanchipuram to buy a sari. However, she went to her mother's house, where Murugan was waiting. Sivarasan wanted the 'human bombs' to get ready for the final strike. At the Kodungaiyur hideout, the women sat together and offered a little prayer in an inner room of the house. Dhanu wore the explosive-laden vest and slipped on the loosely stitched salwar kameez over it. Sivarasan was waiting in the living room. After taking a careful look at Dhanu, he led them to an autorickshaw waiting some distance from the house. Sivarasan didn't want the rickshaw to stand in front of their hideout. He dropped Subha and Dhanu at Nalini's house.

Nalini revealed that Dhanu again said how grateful she was to her leader Prabhakaran for giving her this opportunity to kill a 'traitor'. She then turned to Sivarasan and expressed the same gratitude with a promise that she would not let him down on this mission and that she would not come back alive. Subha expressed gratitude to Nalini for everything she had done for them and noted that Dhanu was going to create history.[12]

Sivarasan and the women visited a temple in the neighbourhood. Dhanu offered a last prayer. Once done, the four left for Parry's Corner to meet Haribabu and take a bus to Sriperumbudur from the terminal.